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Oscene Barrett

Latonya Forrest

Natasha Thomas

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POLICY CONSIDERATIONS FOR GOLF CART TRANSPORTATION: ASSESSING SAFETY, REGULATION, AND COMMUNITY IMPACT IN BRADLEY, ILLINOIS

PRACTICAL CAPSTONE PROJECT

BY

Oscene Barrett

Ph.D. and BS, University of the West Indies, 2006/2012

Latonya Forrest

BS, Technical Management , DeVry University, 2009

Natasha Thomas

BA, Recreation and Sport Administration, Chicago State University, 2024

CAPSTONE PROJECT REPORT

Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements.

For the Degree of Master of Public Administration

Governors State University

December 2025

WE, THE UNDERSIGNED MEMBERS OF THE COMMITTEE,

HAVE APPROVED THIS CAPSTONE

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BY

Oscene Barrett

Latonya Forrest

Natasha Thomas

COMMITTEE MEMBERS

Natalia Ermasova, Ph.D. (Chair)

Public Administration

Robert Romo

Public Administration, Village of Bradley

Craig Anderson, MOL

Public Administration, Village of Bradley

Governors State University

University Park, IL 60484

December 2025

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Introduction

The Village of Bradley (VoB) entered a collaborative relationship with Governors State University (GSU), College of Arts and Sciences, Division of Arts and Letters, Public Policy and Administration Unit for the Fall 2025 semester. The VoB has a small-town environment, with hopes of reversing the decline in population and developing a new revenue stream (Economic Alliance of Kankakee County, 2024, 2025). The Village of Bradley has a motto of "Proud of Our Past, Focused on Our Future". Its name was changed from North Kankakee to Bradley in 1895 after the David Bradley Manufacturing Company agreed to move its operations to the growing industrialized area. It sits in the scenic Kankakee River Valley of Illinois and is part of a larger urban area that includes the City of Kankakee and the Villages of Manteno and Bourbonnais in Kankakee County. The Village has a current population of approximately 15,695 people (U.S. Census, 2024). According to the Village of Bradley (2021), the median household income in Bradley is projected to increase by 9% from $61,800 to $67,400 by 2024 (U.S. Census, 2025). Bradley is a major employment center and is growing in tourism (CSL, 2022). Approximately 14,700 people are employed in Bradley's two zip codes (Village of Bradley, 2021). This accounts for over 36% of jobs in the County/MSA. Retail accounts for about one-third of the local workforce, including those employed in retail, hospitality, and food services (Bryson, 2018). Retail employment has remained stable despite major changes within the retail sector. Industrial is the second largest component of the VoB's workforce (Village of Bradley, 2025). Despite some employment losses in the early 2000s, industrial employment has rebounded since 2010. Recent growth in the manufacturing, transportation, and warehousing sectors has offset declines in Construction employment. The healthcare and professional, and business services sectors appear to be the fastest-growing private employment sectors (Provost, 2023). Office growth has been driven by growth in the professional, scientific and technical services sector, which has increased in more than 550 employees since 2002. The healthcare sector similarly added approximately 525

employees between 2002 and 2017. Overall, employment has remained stable, with a +0.4% CAGR in total employment between 2002 and 2017.

While employment has been stable, two key anchors along the Kinzie Avenue/Route 50 Corridor have recently begun major expansion plans, which are anticipated to bring over 1,000 new employees to unincorporated areas adjacent to Bradley (Nugent & Morrey, 2024). Both the CSL Behring expansion and Nucor expansion will create a combined 1,000 new jobs (CSL, 2022).

Needs Assessment

The Village has shown interest in exploring alternative mobility strategies, particularly the adoption of regulated golf carts (GCs) as neighborhood vehicles, to enhance transportation convenience, support community activities, and promote environmentally responsible mobility practices. Golf carts offer an affordable, environmentally responsible, and easily accessible means of local transportation while the village investigates new and creative modes. The effective adoption of golf cart laws by several nearby municipalities has enhanced neighborhood connectivity, reduced traffic, and stimulated local businesses.

Many municipalities across Illinois have adopted GC ordinances requiring registration, inspection, valid licensing, and insurance; these jurisdictions include Antioch, East Dundee, Holiday Hills, Huntley, Mackinaw, Manhattan, Maple Park, Mazon, New Lenox, Rossville, Winthrop Harbor, and Channahon.

The debate over golf carts in community centers on whether they should be permitted on public roads, weighing the benefits of increased mobility and neighborhood connectivity against concerns about safety and infrastructure. Proponents highlight benefits such as increased neighborhood interaction, convenient short-distance travel, and environmental advantages (with electric carts), while opponents and cautious officials emphasize potential safety hazards, the inadequacy of existing infrastructure, and the need for further studies to ensure public safety.

Goals and objectives

The goal of this practical project is to determine whether introducing or expanding golf cart transportation in the Village of Bradley is feasible, beneficial to the community, and poses any hazards. The objective is to promote sustainable transportation options, increase mobility, and foster community ties for both locals and tourists.

The Village of Bradley seeks to determine whether a comparable program is feasible, publicly supported, and safe.

This capstone explores three primary research questions:

1. Can golf carts function as a viable mode of local transport in Bradley?

2. How do residents perceive the risks, benefits, and desirability of a GC program?

3. What administrative, legal, and operational structures are required for safe and effective implementation?

This practical project measures public opinion, demand, and willingness to engage in the program to ascertain the community's interest and preparedness for golf cart transportation. Potential benefits will also be examined, including increased social interaction among locals, reduced automobile emissions that benefit the environment, and improved accessibility for individuals with mobility issues. Additionally, it assesses potential risks, including maintenance issues, safety concerns, and enforcement challenges, while identifying ways to mitigate them. Lastly, the assessment considers how the implementation of golf cart transportation aligns with Bradley's long-term mobility goals and community involvement objectives, ensuring the project promotes connected neighborhoods and sustainable growth.

Goals and Objectives

For the Fall 2025 semester, Master of Public Administration Capstone students were tasked with contributing to the village’s efforts by assisting in assessing golf cart transportation and its potential impact on safety, economics, and community.

Goal 1: Assess Community Infrastructure

Objective 1.1: Evaluate the Village of Bradley's existing road infrastructure to determine its suitability for golf cart use.

Objective 1.2: Develop a detailed map identifying roads where golf carts are permitted, restricted, and where crossings are allowed to ensure safety and compliance.

Goal 2: Evaluate Community Interest and Support

Objective 2.1: Design and administer a survey to residents and local businesses to measure interest in permitting golf carts on village streets.

Objective 2.2: Analyze survey data to inform policy decisions and assess public readiness for golf cart transportation.

Goal 3: Establish Regulatory Framework

Objective 3.1: Draft an ordinance outlining specific regulations for golf cart operation, including safety equipment standards, driver eligibility, and designated routes.

Objective 3.2: Create the ordinance through the appropriate village governance processes.

Goal 4: Implement a Permitting System

Objective 4.1: Create a formal permitting process for golf cart registration and inspection.

Objective 4.2: Develop administrative procedures to ensure compliance and recordkeeping for registered vehicles.

Goal 5: Educate and Inform the community

Objective 5.1: Prepare a press release to inform residents of new regulations and safe operating practices.

Objective 5.2: Promote awareness of the benefits and responsibilities associated with golf cart use to encourage community-wide compliance and safety.

Literature Review

Across the United States, golf carts have expanded into airports, campuses, retirement communities, and residential areas due to their affordability, ease of operation, and strong consumer appeal. Recent studies highlight a growing public health concern related to injuries caused by golf carts. Evidence shows that golf cart–related incidents have increased steadily over the past decade, particularly among vulnerable populations such as children, older adults, and individuals impaired by alcohol. National injury trend data from the United States indicate a rise from approximately 5,490 cases in 2010 to more than 6,500 cases annually by 2017–2019 (Lau, Esbati, & Cusimano, 2024).

Lau, Esbati, and Cusimano (2024) demonstrate that children are disproportionately affected, with one study reporting that over half of golf cart–related injuries involved children aged 12 and younger. Although many injuries are superficial, a significant proportion involve serious or fatal trauma, especially to the head and neck region.

The literature identifies several common contexts for golf cart use that contribute to heightened risk. Golf courses, university campuses, farms, and private properties often fall outside traditional road safety regulations, allowing golf carts to operate without the safety standards applied to on-road vehicles. Alcohol consumption is also a consistent risk factor; studies show that nearly 60% of injured riders over age 16 had alcohol in their system at the time of the incident, often exceeding legal limits (Lau, Esbati, & Cusimano, 2024). These conditions create an environment in which unsafe operation and inadequate safety measures coincide with increased exposure to injury risks.

Existing research also reviews the limitations of the current golf cart design. Most models include basic features such as mirrors, reflectors, and emergency brakes, but they lack common automotive safety protections. Seatbelts, lap bars, side doors, roll cages, and airbags are rarely incorporated. As a result, ejection during collisions or rollovers remains a

primary mechanism of injury. Studies consistently find that more than half of golf cart injuries involve occupants being thrown from the vehicle. Pediatric evidence suggests that seat belt use is extremely low, which correlates strongly with higher injury severity scores.

The regulatory landscape surrounding golf cart use is inconsistent across jurisdictions. Municipal and provincial governments in Canada vary widely in their approaches, with some regions piloting programs that restrict golf cart operation to certain road types, impose maximum speed limits, prohibit impaired driving, and establish minimum age requirements for passengers. In contrast, U.S. regulatory frameworks for low-speed vehicles impose stricter safety standards, including mandatory seatbelts, windshields, and lighting. Existing literature suggests that Canada lacks a comparable national standardization and that uniform federal or provincial regulations could help reduce injuries. Finally, scholars emphasize the need for stronger enforcement, clearer penalties for impairment, and insurance-based incentives to promote safe operation. Enhanced surveillance systems, such as improved reporting within hospital-based injury databases, are recommended to better monitor emerging trends and assess the impact of policies. Overall, the literature converges on the conclusion that golf cart injuries are preventable, and that safety will improve only through a combination of engineering changes, regulatory reforms, and public education. In Illinois, several communities have formally adopted ordinances for limited GC use on public roads with posted speed limits of 35 mph or less, provided drivers meet registration, insurance, and equipment requirements

The Village of Mattoon requires a registration fee of $150, which will be collected at the time of registration on any date between January 1st and June 30th of each year (City of Mattoon, 2025). For any registration occurring between July 1st and December 31st of any year, a registration fee of $75 will be collected. Registration will remain valid for only the calendar year it was purchased and will expire on December 31st of each year. In the Village

of Mattoon, all passengers must wear a seat belt, and any child still requiring a child safety seat.

Registration is $35 per year, payable to the City of Pontiac. All golf carts must be registered at the Pontiac police department. The registration sticker is valid through March 31st of the following year. It must be attached to the rear of the vehicle and centered in a location that is conspicuous to the driver of a police vehicle behind the Golf Cart. The sticker shall be at least 12 inches from the ground. The vehicle must meet all the standards of a non-highway vehicle plus safety modifications as set forth in Sec 21-90 of the Code of Ordinances of the City of Pontiac.

The intention of the City of Pontiac Golf Cart ordinance is to allow golf cart operation on the City streets with a speed limit of 35 Miles per Hour or less for golf carts that have been modified to the equipment specifications of a Low-Speed Vehicle as defined by 49 CFR 571.500. All operators must have a valid driver's license. It is ultimately the operator’s responsibility to learn those differences and verify compliance with the appropriate statute and ordinance.

Properly Equipped Neighborhood Golf Cart in the City of Pontiac shall have the definition as currently set forth in Section 11-1426.1 of the Illinois Vehicle Code, 625 ILCS 5/11-1426.1, and shall be equipped with all safety systems and equipment as required by said statute, together with seatbelts and windshield. To be operated on a roadway in the City, a golf cart must have at a minimum brakes, a steering apparatus, tires, a rearview mirror, red reflectorized warning devices in the front and rear, a slow moving emblem on the rear of the golf cart, a headlight that emits a white light visible from a distance of 500 feet to the front, a tail lamp that emits a red light visible at least 100 feet from the rear, brake lights, turn signals, a windshield and seat belts.

A Properly Equipped Neighborhood Golf Cart shall be permitted to cross a State highway only at an intersection controlled by a traffic light or a 4-way stop sign and where the State highway has a speed limit of 35 miles per hour or less at the place of crossing. Other than Properly Equipped Neighborhood Golf Carts, which may be operated on the roadways of the City in accordance with this article, no Non-Highway Vehicles, as defined in said Section 11-1426.1, shall be permitted to be operated on the roadways of the City. All golf carts registered must be equipped with functional equipment as outlined in the ordinance. Operators must always obey the rules of the road, as per the Illinois State Statute, while operating the golf cart. In the Village of Mattoon, operators of golf carts must be at least 18 years of age and have a valid driver's license to register/operate a golf cart on a city street. A golf cart can not be operated upon a state highway or any city street where the speed limit exceeds 30 miles per hour in the Village of Mattoon. These prohibited roads may be crossed only at the marked golf cart crossing intersections as outlined on the map below. Prohibited roads for travel are marked in red, while allowable routes are marked in green. The only allowable crossings of prohibited roads are marked with a blue circle. Violations of this section will result in enforcement action by the Mattoon Police Department and may be subject to fines of not less than $50 and not more than $750 per violation.

Bradley shares several characteristics with Illinois communities already permitting GCs:

1. A suburban, middle-income population.
2. A centralized commercial district with shopping, restaurants, and community gathering spaces.
3. Multiple parks and recreation facilities with large parking areas.
4. Strong community involvement in seasonal festivals and parades.

These structural and social attributes make Bradley a logical candidate for adopting a GC mobility program.

Literature review suggests that GC injuries can be significantly reduced through:

1. Mandatory seat belts and child restraints.
2. Speed limitations.
3. Night-time lighting requirements.
4. Restrictions on roads above 35 mph.
5. Strict enforcement of licensed driving.
6. Prohibition of alcohol consumption while driving.

Methodology

As shown above, many cities in Illinois and other states are implementing GC programs with numerous benefits. Some of the benefits are:

- Strong sense of community
- Better Stewards of the Environment
- Convenience for residents who want to enjoy the beautiful village of Bradley
- Increase in revenue by renewed interest in current village activities,
    - Provides opportunities for:
        - Local businesses through increased traffic
        - New Businesses – golf cart repair shops, golf cart parts shops, golf cart dealers, etc.

The village of Bradley, a small middle-class community of about 15500 residents, known for its strong sense of community, wanted to add a GC program to further strengthen the community bond. It was recognized that a GC program would lead to five immediate benefits:

1. Golf carts are an inexpensive and environmentally friendly neighborhood-based means of transportation
    a. Lower emissions
    b. EV options will lower the carbon footprint

2. Golf carts' popularity is rising – we could say they are highly popular in the community.
    a. Youth aged 16-40 love them.
    b. 40+ are craving them
3. Relatively safe with reasonable regulations such as speed limits, rails, safety belts, and proper lighting.
    a. Compared to Cars/bikes/Scooters
4. They could be a good addition to our existing community events,
    a. Christmas tree light parade
    b. Trick or Treat for Halloween
5. They could be the genesis for new community events
    a. Summer Movie Night in the Park
    b. Best Dress GC Parade Spring Event

Importantly, to start a GC program in VoB, there was three pressing question that needed to be answered.

- First, can this program work in Bradley?
    - Will it work in Bradley?
    - Will we yield similar or better results
- Second, what would be the resident's perception of this program?
    - Would it be something they are interested in?
    - Would they support such an idea?
    - What would be some of their concerns?
- Third, how would it be implemented?
    - What are the specific things that need to be in place to facilitate this implementation?

As such, the project was designed to address those three issues.

Data Collection

A literature review was conducted to compare VoB with other cities that have a GC program. This allows for an analysis, which allows for the determination of "Can VoB host a successful GC program."

To evaluate how residents perceive the risks, benefits, and desirability of a GC program, a community survey was developed during the project to gather input from local business owners and residents regarding their support for and plans for using golf cart transportation.

A community survey was administered to gauge resident perceptions regarding the desirability, safety, and feasibility of implementing golf cart use in the Village of Bradley. Although specific sample size and methodology details were not provided in the presentation, the results offer qualitative insight into resident opinions and concerns.

The survey included questions related to:

1. General perceptions of GC use in Bradley.
2. Residency requirements for GC permit eligibility.
3. Perceived safety risks.
4. Potential benefits for community life, events, and local businesses.
5. Support or opposition to the proposed ordinance.

The survey had the following questions:

1. Do you support allowing golf carts to be driven in the Village of Bradley?

- Strongly support
- Somewhat support
- Somewhat oppose
- Strongly oppose
- Do not know

2. What is your perception of golf cart driving in the Village of Bradley?
    - Very safe
    - Somewhat safe
    - Somewhat dangerous
    - Very dangerous
    - No opinion
3. How much should be the maximum speed of a golf cart in the Village of Bradley?
    - 35
    - 30
    - 25
    - 20
4. Should applicants for permits must reside within the corporate limits of the Village of Bradley
5. Please indicate your connection to Bradley (check all that apply):
    - Resident of Bradley
    - Work in Bradley
    - College student (18+), non-resident
    - Visitor/Other
6. **What concerns, if any, do you have about golf cart use in Bradley?**

    (Open-ended response)
7. **What benefits, if any, do you see in allowing golf carts in Bradley?**

    (Open-ended response)
8. **Any additional comments or suggestions?**

    (Open-ended response)

Finally, roadways, pathways, and event spaces suitable for golf cart access were identified through observation and site evaluation during a visit to the Village of Bradley. This, along with the perception survey, enables the development of a GC program for VoB that is ready for implementation.

Findings

There were 24 respondents to the survey. Using the average residential population of Bradley as 15,500, a total of 385 respondents was needed for a statistically representative sample. Therefore, with only 24 people responding to the survey, not representative of the population. As such, it should not be used as the basis for policy consideration. However, the findings will be discussed below.

The purpose of the data was to gauge residents' perceptions of the Golf Cart (GC) program. It was important to get a feel for where the population was on:

1. Their support of GC
2. How safe are GCs
3. Who should be allowed to apply for a permit
4. What concerns do they have
5. What are some of the benefits to be derived from the program

Having the baseline will inform our information campaign, but more importantly, it allows for an immediate evaluation of the program's feasibility.

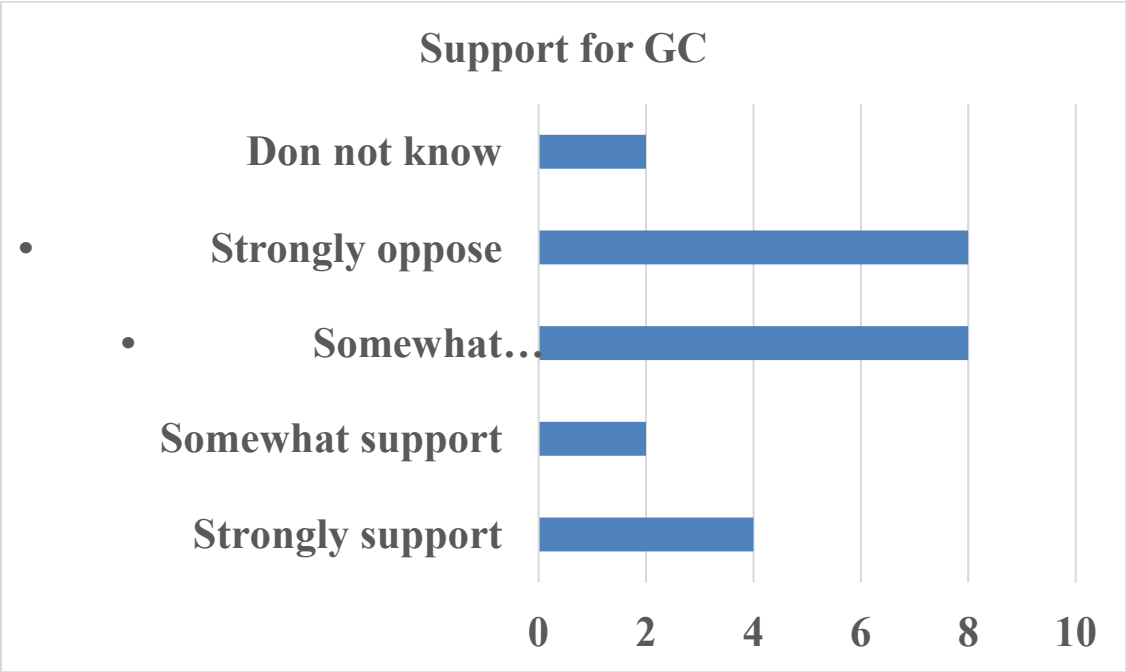

Figure 1

The survey showed that 32% of the population strongly opposed GC compared to only 16% who strongly supported it (See Figure 1). The majority of the population were in the middle, somewhat opposed/supported (52%). This appears to be driven by concerns about the safety of GC on city streets. Almost 80% of the respondents believed that GC is very to somewhat dangerous (Figure 2). The comments provide more detailed information on safety, like

- Dangerous Roadways
- Avoid busy or Dangerous Roads – Armor, Route 50, Kenny, and Route 45 (these have a speed limit above 35 mph.
- Traffic congestion – speed issues
- Kids driving
- Not obeying traffic safety laws
- Crossing busy Roadways

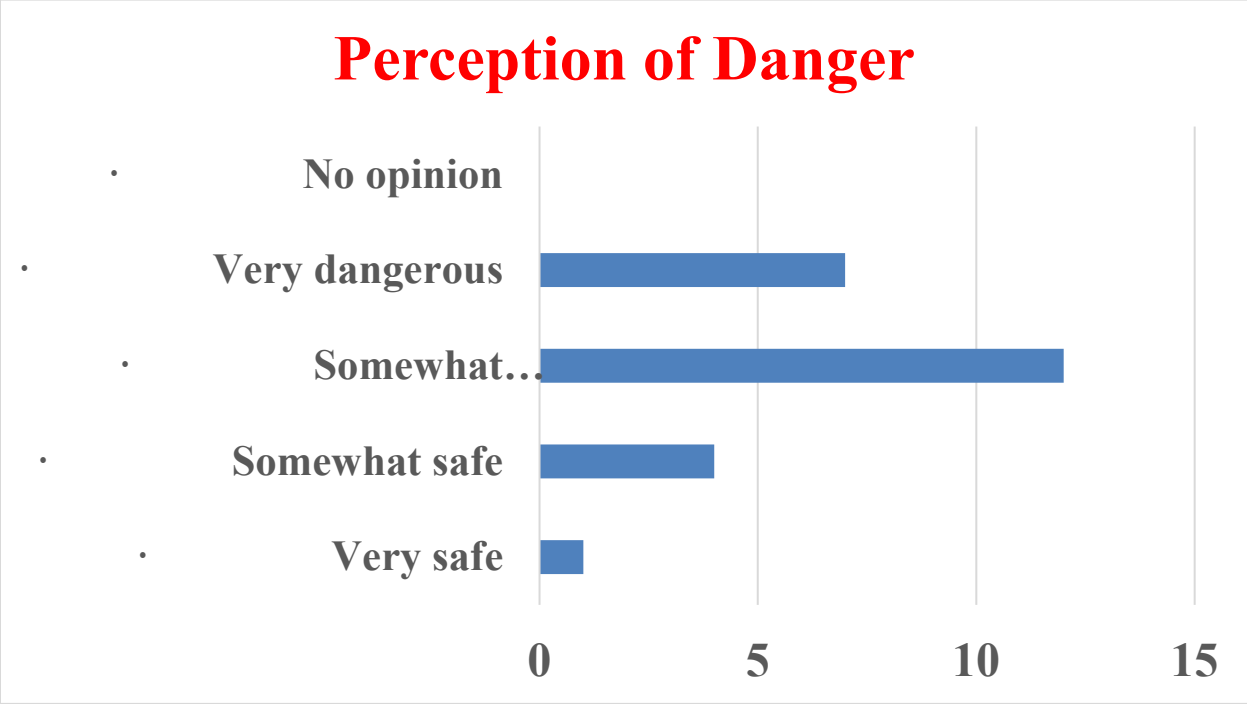

Figure 2a

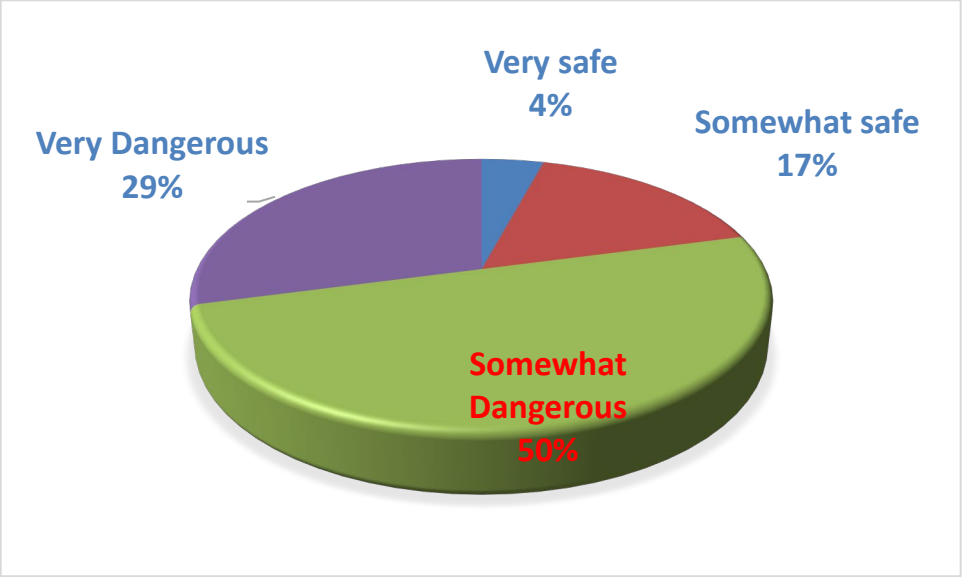

Figure 2b

As a result, a strong GC program in Bradley must be based on robust and verifiable safety protocols. This must address most, if not all, of the citizens' concerns. Additionally, because the opposition was large around safety, it reveals that the citizenry can be persuaded by a village that

values their Concerns, which would be the foundation on which an information campaign can be launched.

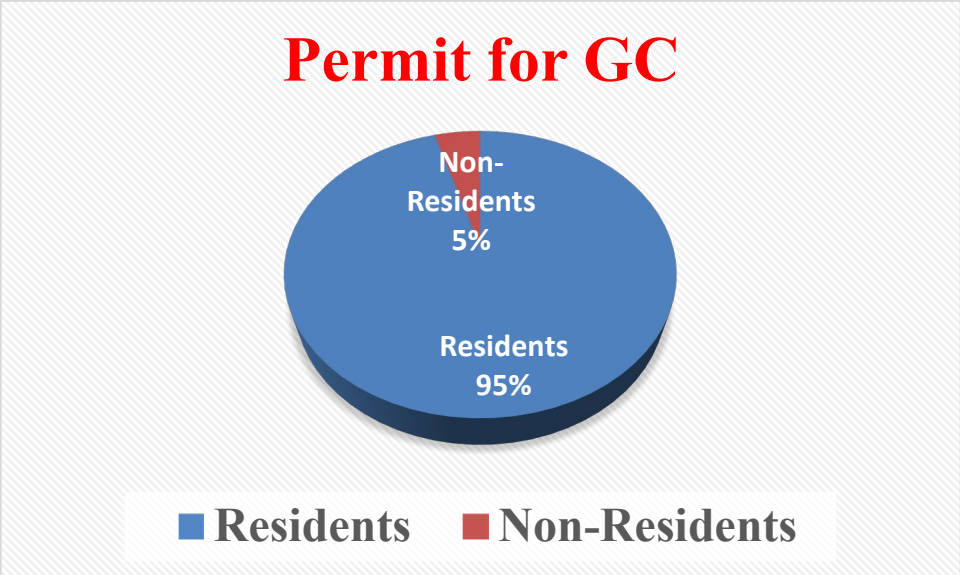

Figure 3

Regarding the question of who should be allowed to apply for a permit, 95% of the respondents want permitting to be exclusive to those who live in Bradley (Figure 3). This should not be interpreted to preclude the possibility of having GC rental companies operating in Bradley that are open to visitors to rent and operate within the village of Bradley proper. Surprisingly, 42% wanted a speed limit of 20 mph on the golf cart, which is lower than most village roads (Figure 4). It would have been interesting to know if this was arguing against no GC, since reducing the speed limit on most of the village streets is a near-impossible task, living in the realm of wishful thinking. Another 33% believe the allowed speed limit for GC should be 25 mph, and zero think it should be 35 kph. Apart from the changes to the posted speed limit required for allowed GC speed between 20 and 25 mph, this posed the risk of creating more frustration, leading to increased aggressive driving. So, as you will see later, 35 mph was chosen.

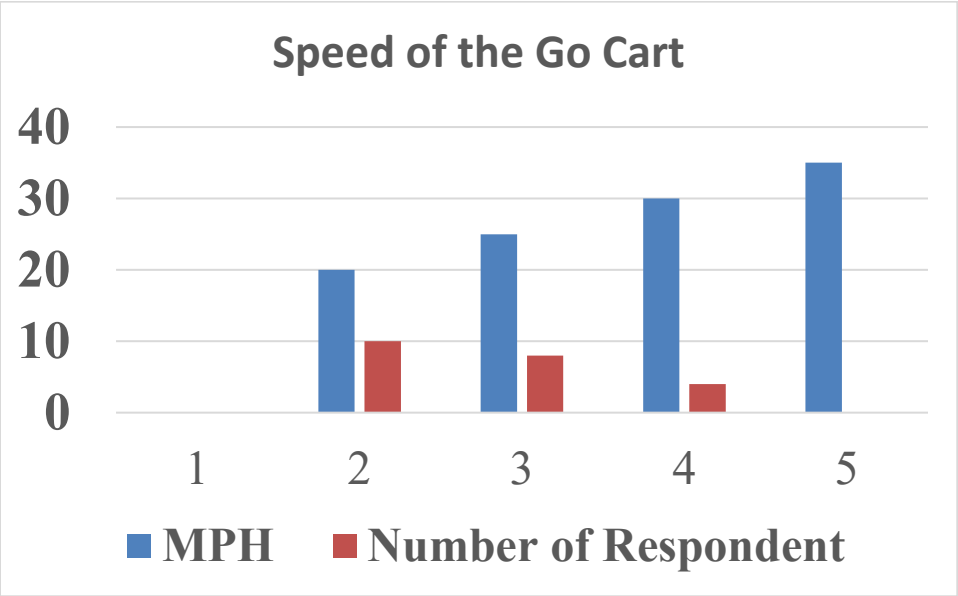

Figure 4

Although safety issues dominate the respondents' minds, many could see the possible benefits that could be derived from the program. Some of the benefits include the following:

- Fun
- Cost-effective transportation
- Low emission and good for the environment
- Flexible means of transport
- Good for community events
- None

The need for these is important and should not be undervalued. Not surprisingly, youths (16-40) are the most interested in GC.

Creation and Implementation Proposal (Practical Project)

Having created a liability waiver (Appendix A), permit application with an inspection form (Appendix B), GC ordinance (Appendix C), press release (Appendix D), and a VOB GC page, it's time to implement. Below is a suggested implementation plan for the village:

1. Adoption and passage of a formal GC ordinance (already drafted).
2. Establishing a GC implementation team.

3. Creating permitting systems, inspection forms, and official stickers.
4. Developing financial and administrative accounts for the program.
5. Launching a Village GC website that consolidates rules, registration links, and safety information (already drafted).
6. Issuing a press release to introduce the program (already drafted).
7. Providing ongoing education through Village media and community outreach initiatives.
8. Mapping authorized/unauthorized roads.

Due to the fact that it is impossible to access the strip mall, restaurants, sports complex, and groceries north of Armour Drive and Route 50 without taking Cardinal Drive and Route 50, which are not only busy but also have posted speed limits exceeding 35 mph, a phased rollout was suggested. In Phase One, the GCs are only allowed to drive on Roads with a posted speed of 35 mph or less.

In Phase Two, the city must put in the infrastructure requirements or make legislative fixes to allow for GC north of Amour and Route 50. Infrastructure will require a GC drive pad, which could be advertised as multiple-use paths, either off Cardinal or Route 50, or both. A more affordable option is available through the village government in the form of new legislation. This would reduce the posted speed limit on Cardinal or Route 50, or both, north of Armour Road.

Conclusions and Recommendations

The analysis demonstrates that a regulated golf cart program is feasible, publicly acceptable, and beneficial for the Village of Bradley. The municipality's layout, demographics, community culture, and commercial infrastructure align well with Illinois communities already permitting GC use.

Survey results show that residents broadly support the initiative, provided that safety protocols and road restrictions are strongly enforced. Evidence from existing research underscores the importance of a comprehensive safety strategy that includes mandatory equipment, licensed drivers, nighttime restrictions, and strict boundaries on high-speed corridors. Speed limits, adequate lighting, and insurance requirements, however, have all been cited as safety concerns. Nevertheless, by increasing mobility during parades, elder programs, and community festivals, the initiative offers a great chance to improve event and tourism experiences.

The cohort developed Bradley's regulation of golf cars. The Village of Bradley intends to use this group's proposal as a reference in drafting and implementing an official ordinance governing golf cart transportation within the community. The proposed materials emphasize safety, accessibility, and community connectivity while promoting sustainable and locally appropriate mobility options.

Recommendations

1. The Village should adopt and tailor the proposed ordinance to local conditions, ensuring alignment with state laws and best safety practices.
2. The Village should create communication with residents and businesses is essential to maintain transparency and adapt regulations based on feedback.
3. The Village should periodically review the program's outcomes, including accident reports, permit data, and public sentiment, to make evidence-based adjustments.
4. The Village should create permit registration and route signage.
5. The Village should integrate golf carts into event planning, business districts, and senior living communities.

Team provides the following event ideas supporting golf cart usage:

Family & Community Events

- Cruise the Community Day – Neighborhood golf cart parade celebrating local pride.

· Family Fun on Wheels Festival – A park-based showcase with golf cart decorating contests and safety demos.

· Golf Cart Drive-In Movie Night – Residents park carts on the field for an outdoor movie.

· Park-to-Park Adventure Ride – Family scavenger hunt across community parks using golf carts.

Holiday Events

· Holiday Lights Parade – Golf carts decorated with lights for Christmas or July 4th celebrations.

· Spooktacular Cart Crawl – Halloween-themed trick-or-treat route for kids and families.

· Easter Egg Roll & Ride – Community Easter celebration with golf carts helping transport seniors and families.

Charitable & Service Events

· Carts for a Cause – Charity golf cart rally supporting local nonprofits or schools.

· Meals on Wheels Golf Cart Delivery Day – Volunteer carts deliver meals to seniors.

· Green for Good Clean-Up – Community park cleanup day supported by golf cart transport for tools and supplies.

Recreational & Tourism Events

· Historic Bradley Tour by Cart – Guided ride highlighting local landmarks.

· Taste of Bradley Cart Crawl – Carts transport guests between local restaurants and businesses.

· Art on Wheels Pop-Up Tour – Mobile art fair showcasing local artists and musicians.

Senior & Accessibility Initiatives

· Senior Ride-Along Day – Village volunteers offer courtesy golf cart rides for seniors.

· Wellness on Wheels – Partner with local fitness or healthcare providers for mobility-friendly outdoor sessions.

Intergenerational & Educational Events

· Generations on the Go – Senior-Student Service Day: Partner local high school and college student volunteers with senior residents for a day of service and storytelling.

· Campus-to-Community Ride & Learn – Collaborate with Kankakee Community College and Bradley-Bourbonnais High School for an educational mobility project connecting students and seniors.

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Appendix A

WAIVER OF LIABILITY: OPERATION OF GOLF CART/UTV

(Each operator must complete a waiver)

Date _____ Name: _____ PHONE:

_____ Address:

_____

DRIVERS LICENSE NUMBER: _____ STATE: _____

· I hereby acknowledge that there are significant risks inherent in the operation of a golf cart and/or Utility Task Vehicle (collectively herein referred to as the "Vehicle") on a public highway, including serious injury or death. I hereby agree to assume all the risks and liabilities associated with the operation of a Vehicle on a public highway, including serious injury or death to person(s) and/or property damage which may be sustained because of the operation of a vehicle.

· I hereby agree to release, indemnify, defend and hold harmless the Village of Bradley, including the Bradley Police Department and its Village President, Village Board, Village Administrator, Police Chief, officers, employees, instructors, personnel, staff, representative, agents, administrators, successors and assigns (collectively referred to as "Village") for any and all known and unknown liabilities, claims, losses, costs, expenses, demands, suits, damages, proceedings, actions, and causes of action, including but not limited to, property damage, personal injury, death, or other claims to any person or property, and shall pay any settlements, judgments, and awards of any type, nature, or description, including paying all Village's attorneys, consultants, and expert witness fees, and all other fees costs or expenses having any logical or factual relationship to or claimed to be proximately, directly or indirectly caused, attributable to or due to some act, error,

omission or activity of the Village or associated with operation of a vehicle on a public highway.

· I hereby waive and relinquish all claims which I now have or may subsequently have because of the operation of the Vehicle on a public highway, and fully release and discharge the Village from claims that may arise from the operation of the Vehicle.

· I hereby agree that this agreement is binding on me and my heirs, executors, administrators, legal representatives, successors, and assigns.

· I have read and understand the "Operation of Golf Cart and Utility Task (side-by-side) Vehicle (UTV)" ordinance.

· I also understand that the Village of Bradley's interpretation of all the rules and regulations is final.

· I furthermore ensure that I will obey all the rules and regulations set forth by the Village of Bradley concerning the operation of the Vehicle within the Village limits.

Signature: _____ Witness: _____

Print: _____ Print: _____

Date: _____ Date: _____

Appendix B

Golf Cart/UTV Permit Application & Checklist

Name: _____ Driver's License #: _____

State: _____ Address: _____, Bradley, IL 60410

Make: _____ Model: _____

Serial Number/VIN: _____ Year: _____

General Description: _____

Insurance Carrier: _____ Policy Number: _____

ADDITIONAL OPERATORS

(complete "Waiver of Liability" for each)

Name: _____

Address: _____

Name: _____

Address: _____

Name: _____

Address: _____

Name: _____

Address: _____

Golf Cart/UTV Check Sheet

- Headlights
- Valid Driver's License

- Liability Insurance
- Brakes
- Steering Wheel
- Red Reflective Warning Device (F/R)
- Brake Lights
- Rearview Mirror
- Slow Moving Vehicle emblem (rear)
- Turn Signal (F/R)
- Windshield
- Horn or Warning Device
- Tail Lamps
- Safety Belts
- No home build/kit
- Four (or more) tires
- (UTV) Engine less than 1,200cc
- (UTV) Non-straddle seating
- (UTV) OEM Muffler
- (UTV) < 64” in width
- (UTV) Dry GVW less than 2,000#
- (UTV) Titled with SOS (for UTV manufactured after January 1, 1998)

I swear or affirm that the information provided herein is true and accurate,

Completed by: _____ Reviewing Officer #: _____

Signature Date: ____/____/_____ _____ Printed Name

Permit Issued: YES NO By: _____ (Initials) Permit Number: _____

If No, Why? _____

Sticker Expiration: December 31, 20___ @11:59pm Fee Paid: $_____

TO BE COMPLETED BY RECORDS

Appendix C

Golf Cart Ordinance

Municipality Authority:

The Illinois Department of Transportation (IDOT) and the Illinois Vehicle Code do not outright prohibit golf carts on all roads; instead, they allow local municipalities to permit their use on designated roadways with speed limits of 35 mph or less.

Golf carts are not allowed on State/Federal Highways and County Roads. This includes interstates, toll roads, federal highways, or other controlled-access routes.

1.1 DEFINITIONS.

For this subchapter, the following definitions shall apply unless the context clearly indicates or requires a different meaning.

COUNTY ROADS.

Any road under the jurisdiction of Kankakee County or the Kankakee County Highway Department.

GOLF CART.

A vehicle specifically designed and intended for the purposes of transporting one or more persons and their golf clubs or maintenance equipment while engaged in the playing of golf, supervising the playing of golf, or maintaining the condition of the grounds on a public or private golf course, and having a maximum speed of 35 miles per hour.

STATE ROADS.

Any road under the jurisdiction of the Illinois Department of Transportation. STATE ROADS include U.S. Route 6, Interstate 55, and frontage roads.

TOWNSHIP ROADS.

Any road under the jurisdiction of a township road district.

UTILITY TASK (SIDE-BY-SIDE) VEHICLE (UTV).

- A motorized vehicle designed to travel off-highway primarily.
- 64 inches or less in width; having a manufacturer's dry weight of 2,000 pounds or less;
- with an engine displacement under one thousand two hundred (1,200) cubic centimeters;
- traveling on four (4) or more non-highway tires;
- designed with non-straddle seats for two (2) to six (6) passengers, inclusive of driver,
- and a steering wheel for steering control and maneuvering, except equipment such as lawnmowers.

VILLAGE STREETS.

Any of the streets within the boundaries of the Village of Bradley, except for state and county roads.

1.2 OPERATING REQUIREMENTS.

Golf carts and UTVs may be operated on village streets subject to the following:

(A) The driver is subject to Illinois' mandatory vehicle liability insurance requirements under Sections 7-601 through 7-610 of the Illinois Vehicle Code and must carry proof of such insurance, specifically listing the golf cart or UTV.

(B) A permit sticker/placard issued by the Village shall be affixed and remain constantly visible on the rear of the golf cart or UTV while operating on Village streets.

(C) The driver must be at least 16 years of age and possess a valid driver's license.

(D) Before operating any golf cart or UTV within the Village of Bradley, each operator will have on file a signed waiver of liability as provided by the Village.

(E) When operated on a roadway, a golf cart and UTV shall have their headlights and taillamps illuminated.

(F) The golf cart and UTV shall be equipped with brakes, a steering wheel apparatus, tires, a rearview mirror, windshield, horn or warning device, seat belts for driver and passenger(s), red reflective warning devices in front and rear, an approved slow moving vehicle emblem (as required of other vehicles in Section 12-709 of the Illinois Vehicle Code) on the rear of the golf cart or UTV. This headlight emits a white light visible from a distance of 500 feet to the front, a tail lamp that emits a red light visible from at least 100 feet to the rear, brake lights, and turn signals on both the front and rear.

(G) The golf cart and UTV driver must obey all traffic laws of the State of Illinois and the Village of Bradley regarding the movement and operation of vehicles on the streets and roadways.

(H) Golf carts and UTVs may only be operated on village streets with posted speed limits of 35 miles per hour or less.

(I) This division does not prohibit a golf cart or UTV from crossing a village street at an intersection where the village street has a posted speed limit of more than 35 miles per hour.

(J) A person driving a golf cart or UTV may cross directly upon or across a state road if the state road has a speed limit of 35 miles per hour or less and the crossing is made at an intersection controlled by a traffic light or a four-way stop sign.

(K) The driver must not exceed 35 MPH.

(L) It shall only be operated from sunrise to midnight.

(M) A person who drives or is physically controlled by a golf cart or UTV on a roadway while under the influence is subject to ILCS Ch. 625, Act 5, §§ 11-500 through 11-502, and applicable local ordinances.

(N) Golf carts and UTVs may not be operated on sidewalks or other public property inaccessible to or authorized for vehicular traffic.

(O) No "non-highway" vehicle as defined in ILCS Ch. 625, Act 5, § 11-1426.1 is permitted on village streets, roads, or highways except golf carts and UTVs as defined in section 1.1

1. No aftermarket muffler or exhaust that produces a noise level above the original manufacturer's muffler or exhaust will be permitted.
2. All home-built, or kit-built, golf carts and UTVs are prohibited.
3. No Flashing or Accessory Lighting.

(P) All crossings of streets, roads, and highways permitted by this subchapter must be direct crossings made at an intersection.

(Q) Compliance is required with the following provision of the Illinois Child Passenger Protection Act, whichever is more restrictive:

1. When transporting any child under 8 years of age, the driver shall be responsible for protecting the child by securing them in an appropriate child restraint system. The parent or legal guardian of a child under 8 years shall provide a child restraint system to anyone who transports a child.
2. If the child being transported is under 2 years of age, the driver is responsible for properly securing the child in a rear-facing child restraint system, unless the child weighs 40 pounds or more or is 40 inches or taller in height.

3. For this section, a “child restraint system” means any device that meets the United States Department of Transportation standard designed to restrain, seat, or position children, including a booster seat.
4. A child weighing more than 40 pounds may be transported in the rear seat while only wearing a lap belt if the back seat is not equipped with a combination lap and shoulder belt.

1.3 Prohibited Crossings and Roadway Restrictions

This code shall prohibit it from:

(A) Cross U.S. Route 45/52 (LaGrange Rd/Kennedy Drive) and 50 (Cicero) at any location where there is no ALL-WAY stop sign or Traffic Light.

(B) Operate on Cardinal Drive (North or Armour Rd)

(C) Operate on U.S. Route 45/52 (LaGrange Rd/Kennedy Drive)

(D) Operate on U.S. Route 50 (Cicero),

(E) Operate on any street, highway, or road under the jurisdiction of the Illinois Department of Transportation; or the County Highway Department; or another local unit of government or private entity that has not authorized their use.

(F) Operate upon any street, highway, road, or section thereof, not under the control of the Village of Bradley.

(G) Operate on any street, highway, or road with a posted speed limit of more than 35 MPH.

1.4 Seat Belt Usage Required

Each driver and passenger, regardless of age, in the seats of a golf cart or UTV operated on streets within the Village, shall wear a properly adjusted and fastened seat belt described in the

Illinois Vehicle Code/Village Code; except that wearing seat belts is not required for any of the following:

(A) A driver or passenger possessing a written statement from a physician that such person is unable, for medical or physical reasons, to wear a seat belt.

(B) A driver or passenger possessing an official certificate or license endorsement issued by the appropriate agency in another state or country indicates that the driver or passenger is exempt from wearing a seat belt due to medical, physical, or other valid reasons.

1.5 Common weather-related restrictions

- **Impaired visibility:** The Village of Bradley explicitly prohibits the operation of golf carts when visibility is impaired by fog, smoke, or other weather conditions. Operators must be able to clearly see people and vehicles on the roadway from a distance of 500 feet.
- **Inclement weather:** The Village of Bradley prohibits the operation of golf carts during "inclement weather".
- **Thunderstorms and Lightning:** The Village of Bradley and the National Weather Service consider vehicles with open cabs, such as golf carts, unsafe during thunderstorms and advise against using them in these conditions.

1.6 Permits

(A) No person shall operate a golf cart or UTV on a Village street without obtaining a permit as provided herein. Permits shall expire on December 31 of each year. The cost of the license shall be $50. Applications for a permit shall be made on a form supplied by the Village, shall be executed by the applicant, and shall contain the following:

1. Name and address of applicant
2. Driver's license number
3. Address and phone number
4. Name of liability insurance carrier and policy number
5. The serial number or VIN, make, model, and description of the golf cart or recreational off-highway vehicle
6. Waiver of liability on a form provided by the Village
7. Such other information as the Village may require

(B) No permit shall be granted unless the following conditions are met:

1. The vehicle is titled adequately with the Illinois Secretary of State, if abled or required.
2. A physically disabled applicant or operator must submit a certificate signed by a physician certifying that the applicant can safely operate a golf cart or UTV on Village streets.
3. The applicant must provide evidence of insurance in compliance with the provisions of the Illinois statutes regarding minimum liability insurance for passenger motor vehicles to be operated on the roads of the State of Illinois.

(C) Permits may be renewed upon demonstrating compliance with the requirements for initial license issuance and payment of the permit fee.

(D) Permits are non-transferable

(E) Permit holders must inform the Bradley Police Department within ten (10) days of any change of address, phone number, and/or insurance coverage.

(F) A permit shall be denied for the following reasons:

1. If required, the vehicle is not titled correctly with the Illinois Secretary of State Office.
2. Insurance information cannot be verified.
3. Registered owner does not possess a valid driver's license.
4. The owner has provided false information in their application.
5. Vehicle does not conform to the requirements of this ordinance; or
6. A permit holder cannot safely operate a golf cart or UTV.

1.7 Seizure and Impoundment

Golf Carts and UTVs are subject to seizure and impoundment pursuant to Chapter 97 of the Code of Ordinance, and seizure under Article 36 of the Criminal Code of 1961 or the Criminal Code of 2012.

1.8 Revocation

(A) Any person who violates the provisions of this Chapter may be subject to revocation of permit(s) or non-renewal of license (s), at the discretion of the Police Chief, or designee, and subject to a monetary fine as provided under the general penalty provision 70.99 of this Code.

(B) No refund of the permit fee will be granted in the event of a revocation.

(C) Any golf cart or UTV whose permit was revoked, or non-renewed, for violating any portion of this Chapter, cannot be permitted or operated on any roadway for one (1) year.

(D) Person(s) who violate provisions of this chapter may have their ability to permit any golf cart, or UTV revoked for a minimum of one (1) year.

(E) The Village may suspend or revoke a permit granted under this Chapter if there is evidence that the permit holder cannot safely operate the vehicle on designated roadways.

1.9 Special Events

Notwithstanding Section 1.4 of the Village Code, a golf cart, recreational utility vehicle, recreational off-highway vehicle, and all-terrain vehicle may be operated on approved streets of the Village without a permit issued under Section 1.4 as part of a special event for which the Village has approved; provided, however, that all other provisions of the Village Code, the Illinois Compiled Statutes and all other applicable laws and regulations shall apply to such operation.

1.10 Exemptions

Any golf cart, all-terrain vehicle, off-highway motorcycle, or recreational off-highway vehicle belonging to any municipal, state, county, district, federal, or tribal police, fire, Emergency Management Agency, or anyone requested, summoned, or directed by the same; shall be exempt from this Chapter.

1.11 PENALTY.

(A) Any person who violates any provision of §§ 1.0 through 1.8 shall, upon conviction, be subject to a fine of not less than $100 nor more than $500.

(B) The village can add other penalties related to other village ordinances.

Appendix D

Press Release

VILLAGE OF BRADLEY, IL — The Village of Bradley has enacted a new ordinance regulating the use of golf carts on designated public roadways within the village limits. The ordinance, which took effect earlier this year, establishes clear safety, registration, and operational requirements for residents who wish to operate these vehicles legally in Bradley.

Under the ordinance, golf carts may be driven on approved village streets but are prohibited on state roads, sidewalks, trails, and other non-designated public rights-of-way. The law applies only within the Village of Bradley and does not replace or fulfill requirements in neighboring municipalities. Residents should verify jurisdiction boundaries before operating their vehicles.

The ordinance aims to enhance safety and provide structure for recreational vehicle use in residential areas and on village-maintained roads. Operators must be at least 18 years old and possess a valid driver's license or state-issued photo ID.

To qualify for registration, golf carts must meet minimum safety equipment standards, including:

- Headlights and brake lights
- Turn signals
- A rail
- A full rearview mirror
- Seat belts for each occupant
- Child restraint system.

Vehicles classified as All-Terrain Vehicles (ATVs), three-wheelers, four-wheelers, or slow-moving utility vehicles are not covered under this ordinance. They are not permitted on village streets unless otherwise authorized by Illinois law.

Registered golf carts must not exceed 35 mph and must comply with all traffic laws, including yielding to pedestrians and other vehicles. Golf cars can drive only on streets with posted speed limits of

35 mph or less. Operators must not carry more passengers than the manufacturer's designated capacity, and all passengers must remain seated while the vehicle is in motion.

To register a golf cart, residents must complete an online application. After the application is submitted, the Bradley Police Department will contact applicants to schedule a required vehicle inspection. Upon passing inspection, applicants must bring the signed approval form, proof of insurance, a valid driver's license or ID, and a $50 registration fee to the Bradley Police Department. Accepted payments include cash, credit cards, money orders, and cashier's checks. Personal checks are not accepted.

Once registration is complete, owners will receive a decal that must be affixed to the rear of the vehicle.

Bradley law enforcement officers are authorized to enforce all provisions of the ordinance and may request proof of registration, insurance, or identification at any time. Violations may result in fines ranging from $300 to $3,000, depending on the severity of the offense. Vehicles operating in violation of the ordinance may also be towed or impounded.

For full ordinance details, safety requirements, or to begin the registration process, residents may visit the Village of Bradley's official website or contact the Bradley Police Department.